

have a DVD drive or that your LAN drivers aren't working. Given Linux's reputation for being an OS for "geeks" developers have worked very hard to simplify the installation process, providing support for a very large number of components by default. More often than not, you'll find a popular Linux distro working perfectly directly after installation with no running around for drivers and other tools. We're definitely not saying that Windows doesn't support more hardware, we're just saying that Linux is more user-friendly than most people think it is.

3. It's a steal

If you want to buy an original copy of Windows, be prepared to fork over a lot of money. If you want to run Mac OS X, be prepared to fork over a small fortune. Linux on the other hand is available through multiple sources and a sizeable chunk of what's out there is free. Maintaining one such distro and getting support isn't too hard and you're always assured support from some knowledgeable geek or the other.

4. There's a distro for everything

The sheer variety of Linux distros available to everyone is staggering. As a consequence of this variety, you're assured of a distro for every type of PC you use, be it a 10-year old one powered by a Pentium II or a blazing fast, i7 powered monster. You don't need to worry about upgrading your RAM or about support for aging hardware. There are distros that will run on 32MB of RAM and ones that'll make the most of a Xeon powered workstation. No other OS can offer this degree of flexibility.



Linux: Safe from everything. Includes cute penguins

5. It's fully customisable

With an OS like Windows or Mac OS, you're stuck with what you get. There's a limited degree of customisability available of course, and the more brave among you can even go for shell-replacement, but none of the